NEVISON ALISON

BSc immunology student | Malawi University of Science and Technology

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PROFILE

Immunology student and president of the MUST society of Immunology, with a first-place win in the MLw innovation Week 2026 Diagnostic Pitching Competition for PlasmoID, a proposed five species malaria rapid diagnostic test. I want to build a career in biomedical research and laboratory diagnostics and to use immunology to improve community health in Malawi with much interest in diagnostic immunology for infectious diseases.

EDUCATION

BSc Immunology (2024 to 2028 expected graduation)

Malawi University of Science and Technology (MUST)

- Coursework includes Immunology (Innate and Adaptive immune response, Autoimmunity.
- Studied diagnostic Immunology method like RDT, ELISA and ELISPOT, Electrophoresis for malaria
- Intend to pursue PlasmoID as my final Year project

Secondary School Education

Mkanda Secondary school

- Malawi School Certificate of Education (MSCE) in 2024.

RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

PlasmoID: Five-Species Plasmodium Multiplex Lateral-Flow RDT 2026 – present

Founder and developer

- Developed the idea after seeing that routine RDTs at Mchinji District Hospital detect mainly P. falciparum.

- Aim to extend detection to P. ovale, P. malariae and P. knowlesi.
- Wrote a 29-page scientific audit and a stage-gated development plan.

Implementing and working on Sanitary Pads project

- Working with a team of 4 students on a biodegradable sanitary pad project with Ubhwando Org

AWARDS AND PROGRAMMES

First place, Diagnostic Pitching Competition 31 July 2026.

Malawi Liverpool Wellcome Trust (MLW) Innovation Week

Mentorship-Based Innovation Internship – Starting October 2026

Malawi Liverpool Wellcome Trust (MLW)

- Awarded after winning the pitching competition. Mentorship with MLW contacts in Immunology, diagnostic and commercialisation

Invited Presenter, Youth summit Explosion Innovation Boot Camp 12 September 2026.

Sci4O KUHeS Chapter with Ubhwando (PHA), Mahatma Gandhi KUHeS Library Auditorium

- Invited to showcase PlasmoID and present it as I did at MLW

LEADERSHIP

President, MUST society of Immunology (MUSIM)

- Lead the society and plan its weekly meetings and activities for the semester.
- Run five lineage groups where members research and present short topics

PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE

Hospital Attachment | Mchinji District Hospital | 01 June 2026 – 30 July 2026.

- Performed thick and thin blood films for malaria screening, urinalysis, FBC analysis and blood grouping.
- Also worked at lab reception (data entry, sample collection), serology (CD4+ count, TB and syphilis tests) and microbiology (CSF analysis, culturing).

SKILLS

- Scientific: literature review and critical appraisal, diagnostic assay design (lateral flow), research planning, IP and notebook documentation.
- Professional: leadership, event and programme planning, public speaking and pitching.

Languages: English and Chichewa

MEMBERSHIPS

- MUST society of Immunology (MUSIM), President
- Sci40, member

REFERENCE

Dr Alice Mtalimanga, Head of Innovation Hub, ambewe@mlw.mw

Alick Banda, Mchinji District Lab Manager, 0999386342

Dr David Mzinza, Lecturer in Immunology and Postgraduate Programme Coordinator at MUST, dmzinza@must.ac.mw